

Running Dictations - Sports Special (×3, two levels each)

Name: _____

Date: _____

How running dictation works (in case a colleague needs reminding)

Pin/tape the text somewhere outside the room (corridor, another table across the room). Students work in pairs: one is the **runner**, who goes to read a chunk of the text, memorises it, and comes back to **dictate** it to the **writer**, who writes it down without seeing the original. Runners can go back and forth as many times as needed. First pair to finish with an accurate text wins – swap roles halfway through if you want both students running.

Reference: connectors (put on the board before starting)

Simple (A1-A2)	Richer (B1-B2)
and, but, so	moreover, however, as a result
first, next, then, after that	in addition, meanwhile, therefore
finally	firstly / secondly / finally
because	since, although, whereas

Reference: adverbs of frequency (for the horse riding text)

100%	~90%	~70%	~50%	~10%	0%
always	usually	often	sometimes	rarely	never

Position rule: before the main verb (*you always check...*), but after the verb "to be" (*you are never late*).

1. Horse riding - adverbs of frequency + connectors

Weaker version (~85 words)

Before you ride, you always check your riding hat. You always check the girth too, because it holds the saddle in place. You usually use a mounting block to get on. Then you sit up straight and put your heels down. You sometimes trot, but first you always walk. Your coach often says "walk on" or "trot on." You never let go of the reins. At the end, you dismount, and you always thank the horse.

Stronger version (~145 words)

Before you even mount, your coach usually checks your riding hat and the girth, because a loose girth could be dangerous. You often use a mounting block to get on safely; however, more experienced riders occasionally mount without one. Once in the saddle, you always sit up straight, keep your heels down, and look ahead — your coach will rarely let you skip this step. You sometimes start at a walk before moving on to a trot; in addition, you usually hear commands like "walk on" or "trot on" throughout the lesson. You should never let go of the reins completely, although you can relax your grip slightly once you feel confident. Finally, you always dismount carefully and, as a tradition, most riders thank the horse afterwards.

Follow-up exercise (for merging into the horse riding worksheet)

Put the adverb in the correct place. Rewrite each sentence with the adverb correctly positioned. 1. You check your girth before mounting. (*always*) 2. Riders forget their riding hat. (*never*) 3. Beginners use a mounting block. (*usually*) 4. You are late for your first lesson. (*rarely*) – (*tricky one* – "to be" sentence) 5. Experienced riders mount without help. (*sometimes*)

2. Tennis - connectors

Weaker version (~80 words)

First, you learn how to hold your racket. It's a bit like shaking someone's hand. Next, you point your racket where you want the ball to go. The coach often uses softer balls at the start, because they bounce more slowly. Then you learn to volley, which means hitting the ball before it bounces. You don't swing for a volley — you just push the racket forward. After that, you bring your racket back to the middle. Finally, you practise your forehand again and again.

Stronger version (~130 words)

Before you hit a single ball, your coach checks your grip, comparing it to a handshake. Once that's right, the focus shifts to direction: you simply point the racket where you want the ball to go. At first, coaches often use softer, slower-compression balls, since they give beginners more time to react rather than feeling rushed. Later, you move on to volleys — hitting the ball before it bounces — which requires a short push forward rather than a full swing. Moreover, after every shot, you're expected to bring your racket back to a central, ready position, so that you're prepared for whatever comes next. As a result, even a simple rally becomes a constant rhythm of preparing, hitting, and resetting.

Follow-up exercise (for merging into the tennis worksheet)

Connector gap-fill. Fill each blank with a connector from the box (some can be used more than once): *first / then / because / after that / however / moreover / as a result* 1. __, **you learn how to hold the racket.** 2. **The coach uses softer balls** _ **they bounce more slowly.** 3. **, you learn to volley.** 4. **You push the racket forward;** , **you don't swing at all.** 5. __, even a simple rally becomes a steady rhythm.

3. Basketball - connectors

Weaker version (~75 words)

In basketball, you can't carry the ball for more than two steps without dribbling. If you do, that's called travelling. You also can't stop dribbling and then start again — that's a double dribble. If you touch another player who has the ball, that's a foul. If you step outside the lines with the ball, the other team gets it. There are two ways to score: a layup, close to the basket, or a jump shot, from anywhere on the court.

Stronger version (~135 words)

Basketball has a small set of rules that shape almost everything that happens on court. Firstly, travelling occurs when a player holds the ball and takes more than two steps without dribbling; similarly, a double dribble happens if a player stops dribbling, holds the ball, and then starts dribbling again. In addition, any illegal contact with a player who has possession counts as a foul, while stepping outside the boundary lines while holding the ball results in an immediate turnover. As for scoring, there are two main options: a layup, taken very close to the basket while still moving, or a jump shot, which can be taken from almost anywhere on the

court after stopping. Finally, if a shot misses, whoever gains the ball afterwards has completed a rebound.

Follow-up exercise (for merging into the basketball worksheet)

Connector matching. Match each connector to its function. | Connector | Function |
|---|---| | firstly / finally | A. sequence (order of events) | | in addition / similarly | B. adding another point | | while / whereas | C. contrast | | as a result | D. showing a consequence |

Then: rewrite two sentences from the text using a **different** connector with the same function, without changing the meaning.

All three follow-up exercises are designed to slot directly into their matching sport worksheet (horse-riding-activity.md, tennis-activity.md, basketball-activity.md) whenever you're ready to merge everything into master documents per sport.

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About this activity

Weaker and stronger version of each – connectors throughout, adverbs of frequency in the horse riding text